

"Stand Out in a Job Interview"

Amy Gallo | Harvard Business Review | YouTube search: "Stand Out in a Job Interview HBR Amy Gallo"

Name: _____ Period: _____ Date: _____

■ WHAT THIS VIDEO IS ABOUT

Amy Gallo is a contributing editor at Harvard Business Review and an expert on workplace communication. In this video she walks through what it actually takes to stand out in a job interview — not just the obvious stuff, but the strategic moves most candidates miss. She covers how to prepare, how to present yourself, how to handle the conversation in the room, and what to do when things go sideways.

Review Questions — Answer as You Watch or Immediately After

Answer in the space provided. Complete sentences are required.

Question 1 — Preparation

Gallo emphasizes doing your homework before you ever walk into the room. What specific types of preparation does she say candidates should do — and why does showing up unprepared signal more than just not knowing the company?

Question 2 — Telling Your Story

Gallo says candidates need to craft compelling stories, not just list their qualifications. What is the difference between listing your experience and telling a story about it? Why does the story approach work better in an interview setting?

Question 3 — How You Show Up

Beyond what you say, Gallo talks about how you present yourself in the room — eye contact, body language, tone, energy. Pick one nonverbal behavior she mentions and explain specifically how it affects the impression you make on an interviewer.

Question 4 — Handling the Unexpected

Gallo addresses what to do when an interview goes off-script — a tough question, an awkward moment, something you did not prepare for. What is her advice, and why is how you handle pressure a form of self-representation?



Read the scenario carefully. Respond in complete sentences. One-sentence answers will not receive full credit.

Scenario Question

Marcus has an interview at a healthcare facility for a medical assistant position. He researched the company website the night before, shows up in clean but casual clothing — jeans and a hoodie — and when the interviewer asks "Tell me about yourself," he gives a rambling two-minute response about his hobbies and personal life before eventually mentioning his qualifications. He makes minimal eye contact and checks his phone once when it buzzes. He does not ask any questions at the end.

Based on what Gallo covers in the video, identify at least three specific mistakes Marcus made and explain what he should have done differently in each case. Which mistake do you think cost him the most, and why? Respond in at least 4 complete sentences.

